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TAX CREDIT
Shore mayors tout program to reduce income tax bill. 3

ASBURY PARK
Political activist and club owner accused of passing phony checks. 2



'I DO' AGAIN
Twenty couples renew their wedding vows in Sea Girt church.
OUR TOWNS/3



BABY BOOMERS BOOSTING FILMS
Those people born between 1946 and 1964 have more time to go to the movies.
BUSINESS/6

PLUS
Region Briefs 3
Police Briefs 3
Stocks 7, 9

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ASBURY PARK PRESS | FRIDAY, FEB. 21, 2003

LOCAL NEWS

SECTION B

IN BELMAR

School repair called urgent

By TRACY ROBINSON
COASTAL MONMOUTH BUREAU

BELMAR — If the $8.9 million school budget that was introduced last night is approved, the owner of an average assessed home could see an increase of about $44 in school taxes.

The budget and the coming $3.37 million referendum were discussed at last night's Board of Education meeting.

The $8,890,541 budget for the 2003-2004 school year calls for a tax levy of $5,403,750 and a tax rate of 56.7 cents per $100 of assessed property value, School Business Administrator Loretta Hill said.

The budget calls for a 1.4-cent increase in the tax rate for school purposes, which would mean an increase of about $44 in school taxes for the owner of a home assessed at $325,000, the borough average, Hill said.

Last year's $8,890,010 budget called for a school tax rate of 55.3 cents per $100 of assessed property value, she said.

See Repair, Page B4

Rumson to revise zoning plan

By MICHAEL CLANCY
STAFF WRITER

RUMSON — Moved by residents' concerns, the Borough Council agreed last night to rework sweeping revisions to local zoning laws that would have restricted lot subdivisions and prohibited certain uses such as keeping bees, chickens or livestock.

"It takes away your options to use your property the way you want to, whether it be horses or bees," said Chris Brightman, who owns a 6-acre farm with ponies on Rumson Road. "You lose value. It devalues property."

Last night's meeting was the second public hearing on the proposed ordinance. About 25 people attended the council

See Rumson, Page B4

County board OKs college budget

By NINA RIZZO
FREEHOLD BUREAU

Brookdale tuition to rise under 'austerity' spending plan

FREEHOLD — The Monmouth County Board of School Estimate yesterday approved a $84.8 million operating budget for Brookdale Community College for the 2003-2004 school year.

The spending plan, up 7.7 percent over last year, relies on $25,661,888 from tuition and $21,393,721 from the county coffers. The county contributed an additional $921,261, or 4.5 percent, over last year.

"The budget is an austerity budget," Freeholder Thomas J. Powers said after the meeting.

Powers noted that the state, once again, has not provided its third of the budget, as originally agreed upon when community colleges were created. Gov. McGreevey said he intends to cut state aid for community colleges by 5 percent this year to help make up for a $5 billion deficit.

The Middletown-based college, which has 13,000 students, expects to lose $600,000 of last year's $13.9 million state appropriation.

Stephen Nacco, a college spokesman, said the college's board of trustees had

See College, Page B4

BAD WEATHER DELAYS WORK



Spring completion for Kozloski Road

By NINA RIZZO
FREEHOLD BUREAU

FREEHOLD TOWNSHIP — Frigid temperatures and an onslaught of snow this winter will delay the Kozloski Road extension until the spring, engineers said.

Joseph M. Ettore, assistant Monmouth County engineer, said this week's snowstorm halted construction for only a few days, as work crews traded pavement rollers for plows.

"A day or two of inclement weather is surmountable," Ettore said. "It's a string of them that has had a cumulative effect and has imparted the project."

The road, of which 1.5 miles is complete, runs from Route 33 to Route 537.

The $7.5 million project is to extend the road by 1.8 miles from Route 537 north to Route 79, cutting across Dutch Lane Road and running parallel to East Freehold Road.

The lengthening of the road is complete, but crews have not finished widening the adjacent section of Route 537, building a retaining wall along Route 537 and paving Dutch Lane Road.

County Engineer Theodore A. Gianneschini said the harsh winter has hampered efforts to move utility poles, install a traffic light at Dutch Lane Road near the firehouse and complete the paving and striping of the new roadway.

The cost of the project is covered entirely by the state Transportation Trust Fund, which annually awards money to counties for road, bridge and mass transit projects.

Monmouth County has received between $4 million and $4.5 million annually in recent years and has set aside a large portion of those funds for the Kozloski Road extension.



TIM MC CARTHY/Staff Photographer

Winter weather work has been interrupted at Kozloski Road in Freehold Township. The road has been extended for 1.8 miles, but improvements are not complete at Route 537 and at Dutch Lane Road.

Nina Rizzo: (732) 308-7755 or nrizzo@app.com

BLACK HISTORY MONTH

EDITOR'S NOTE: Throughout February the Asbury Park Press is chronicling some area residents' experiences and reflections on race relations.

FINDING 'A SENSE OF SELF'

HOWELL — For the Rev. Caleb E. Oates, many things in Howell have changed since he came to the township 57 years ago, but some things have remained the same.

Oates, 85, has been the pastor of the Bethany Baptist Church on West Farms Road since 1946 and a resident of Howell since 1956. He said when he came to the church, not many African-Americans owned property in Howell.

The church, which was organized at a former one-room schoolhouse in 1938, was serving about nine black families when Oates arrived eight years later.



Oates

Oates, who was ordained at Mount Pisgah Baptist Church in Asbury Park, said most of the breadwinners of those families were potato pickers and farmhands.

If they lived in town, their home was probably a shack and they were tenants of the families that owned the farms, Oates said.

"They didn't have anything," said Oates, who encouraged his congregation to buy land in the township and continues to do so today.

African-Americans now own property in Howell, Oates said, but the township is becoming more affluent and a steady rise in taxes is making it more difficult for working black families to call Howell home.

"Owning property gives a person a sense of self, and (that person) is considered a citizen of the community," Oates said. "Without ownership, you're like a rolling stone within society."

— *Rodney Point-Du-Jour*

DID YOU KNOW:

- *African-American activist Malcolm X, 39, was assassinated on Feb. 21, 1965, in Manhattan's Audubon Ballroom at a rally of his organization. The three men convicted of the crime were sentenced to life imprisonment.*
- *Source: Black Facts Online*

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